

The Held Blow

Player-facing description

The Held Blow: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.

Public role

Clue / evidence

Handout text

Player-safe note: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.

Raw source

- Id: the-held-blow
- Name: The Held Blow
- Type: clue
- Role: Clue / evidence
- Summary: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.
- Tags: clue evidence hidden
- Connections: Sablewood? Logistics Preserve Bramble Union Ambusher
- Pronunciation: the HELD BLOH
- Image Fallback: type-icon
- Clue Profile: clue-profile-v1 the-held-blow the-held-blow The Held Blow The Held Blow the HELD BLOH behavioral True [Atlas lore - confirm or override] The Held Blow In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. the-held-blow The Held Blow the HELD BLOH behavioral they don't actually want to kill; the menace is mostly armor. HIDDEN The Bramble Truth the-bramble-truth Complicates victory over the Bramble and rewards empathy, capture, or careful interrogation. [pages/entities/the-held-blow.html](#) [pages/clues/the-bramble-truth.html](#) In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. they don't actually want to kill; the menace is mostly armor. "did that one just... hold back?" "they're fighting to drive you off, not to kill." You have enough GM-only proof that the Bramble...
- Robust: The Held Blow: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. Use this element to reveal the cost of managed protection through concrete play. Give one concrete visual, one sound or texture, and one sign of who has used or neglected it. Pull attention toward the people, stakes, or infrastructure connected to this

entity. Pressure appears when players treat this as disposable, purely transactional, or unrelated to ordinary lives. Use when players need a tangible handle on the scene's pressure. Knowledge / Instinct / Presence as fits the table 15 Learn the clean fact about The Held Blow and one deeper connection. Learn the useful fact and gain a follow-up question. Learn the fact, but reveal who notices, who is endangered, or what timer advances. Miss the full answer, but gain a sensory clue or safe next step. Misread the pressure and invite a GM move tied to cost, custody, or danger. Spend Fear to reveal the system behind the object, move a threat closer, or make a choice more costly. Loreborne / Knowledge: names the institutional pattern. Wildborne / community: notices local use, neglect, or...

- Personality: Give one concrete visual, one sound or texture, and one sign of who has used or neglected it.
- Wants: Pull attention toward the people, stakes, or infrastructure connected to this entity.
- Fears: Pressure appears when players treat this as disposable, purely transactional, or unrelated to ordinary lives.
- Secrets: Use this element to reveal the cost of managed protection through concrete play.
- Body Language: Give one concrete visual, one sound or texture, and one sign of who has used or neglected it.
- Sample Dialogue: The Held Blow: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.
- Equipment: No equipment; use as context, place, faction, mechanic, or clue rather than treasure.
- Search Or Loot: Player-safe note: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.
- Gm Use: Use when players need a tangible handle on the scene's pressure.
- Future Hooks: Bring back if player choices made this entity emotionally or tactically important.
- Mechanics: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn The Held Blow when it is present in the fiction. Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete. Surface read: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle. entity-the-held-blow-engage-the-held-blow entity-the-held-blow Engage The Held Blow Engage The Held Blow Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of The Held Blow hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but...
- Short Pronunciation: the HELD BLOH
- Meta: Clue / Evidence CLUE assets/icons/clue.png entity-clue #48c7e8 07 Items and Clues entities clue

- Image Prompt: Private table TTRPG story atlas asset for The Held Blow, Clue / Evidence. Role: Clue / evidence. Summary: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.. Cinematic fantasy concept art, readable silhouette, no visible text, no UI, no watermark. Do not include the Strixwolf Mother, strixwolf pups, wolves, owlbeards, or animal companions.
- Related: Bramble Union Ambusher Sablewood? Logistics Preserve
- Image: assets/clue-images/the-held-blow/profile_base.png
- Image Asset Status: clue_visual_profile
- Visual Gallery: primary Primary wiki image primary assets/clue-images/the-held-blow/profile_base.png The Held Blow primary wiki image visual. The Held Blow: Primary wiki image. clue_visual_profile True True

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